

SESSION 5 — BOUT-LENGTH REPEAT EFFORT

60 minutes · conditioning bias · moderate nervous-system cost · needs a flat strip, a bench, a jump rope, two cones

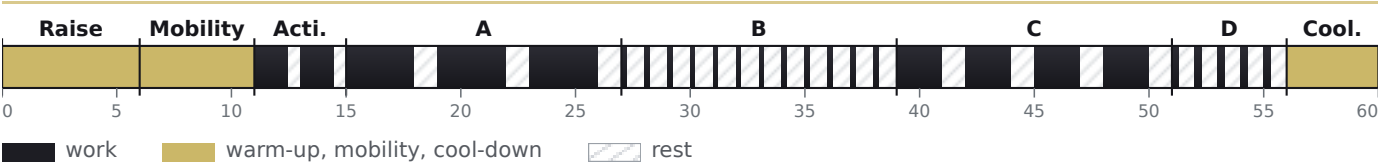
A direct-elimination bout is three periods of three minutes with a minute between them, and inside each period the work comes in bursts of two to eight seconds separated by a few seconds of nothing. This session trains that shape: repeat efforts, short recoveries, and the ability to make the last minute of the third period look like the first minute of the first.

It is the only session in the set where being tired is the point. It is still not a session to grind — the intervals are timed so that quality holds.

Marker for the log: burst count in the final round of block B against the first round. Anything inside 10% is a good day.

Stop rule: technique, not fatigue. When the en garde collapses — back knee falling in, torso leaning — walk that interval and rejoin the next one.

Minute by minute



TIME	BLOCK	WORK AND REST
0:00–0:06	Raise	6 min progressive jog · easy throughout
0:06–0:11	Mobility	Whole-body flow, five movements · easy throughout
0:11–0:15	Activation	2 rounds of 2 min · 90 s work / 30 s rest
0:15–0:27	A — Three periods	3 periods · 3 min work / 1 min rest
0:27–0:39	B — Touch intervals	12 rounds on the minute · 15 s work / 45 s rest
0:39–0:51	C — Mixed circuit	4 rounds of 3 min · 120 s work / 60 s rest
0:51–0:56	D — Last point	5 rounds on the minute · 20 s work / 40 s rest
0:56–1:00	Cool-down	Walk, stretch, breathe · easy throughout

0:00–0:06 · Raise

Easy throughout

Six minutes of jogging that gets progressively quicker: two minutes easy, two minutes steady, one minute at a pace where talking gets awkward, one minute easy again. Breathe through the nose for as long as it stays comfortable.

0:06–0:11 · Mobility, one minute each

Easy throughout

1. Inchworm walkouts, 8, with a push-up at the bottom of the last three
2. World's greatest stretch, 30 s each side
3. Leg swings, 15 each direction each leg
4. Deep squat to stand, 10, reaching overhead at the top
5. Thoracic rotations over the bench, 10 each side

0:11–0:15 · Activation, two rounds of two minutes



2 × 90 s work / 30 s rest

- 20 pogo hops
- 10 bodyweight squats, slow down and fast up
- 8 push-ups
- 20 s hang from the bar
- Rest the remainder of the two minutes

0:15–0:27 · Block A — Three periods



3 × 3 min work / 1 min rest

Three three-minute periods of continuous footwork with a minute of rest between each, then a minute of rest before block B. This is the closest thing in the week to an actual bout.

Inside each period, keep the en garde the whole time and work in bursts: a few seconds of preparation, one committed action, then a reset. Do not jog the three minutes — it is footwork throughout, self-called, with real intent.

- **Period 1 — preparation.** Advances, retreats, changes of rhythm. One lunge roughly every 20 seconds.
- **Period 2 — attacking.** Every 15 seconds, a committed attack: advance-lunge, balestra-lunge, or double advance into a lunge.
- **Period 3 — defending and answering.** Retreat under pressure, then answer with a retreat-lunge or a counter-attack every 15 seconds.

Count your committed actions in each period. Periods 2 and 3 should match.

0:27–0:39 · Block B — Touch intervals



12 × 15 s work / 45 s rest

Twelve rounds on the minute: 15 seconds all-out, 45 seconds walking. This is the work-to-rest ratio of a real bout, held for twelve exchanges.

Set a cone at each end of a 10 m run. Each 15-second burst: from en garde at one cone, advance-lunge, recover, sprint to the far cone, turn, sprint back, en garde, lunge again. Count the lunges completed in the 15 seconds.

Record round 1 and round 12. That pair of numbers is the session marker and, run week after week, is the clearest evidence of conditioning the club can collect without any equipment at all.

0:39–0:51 · Block C — Mixed circuit



4 × 120 s work / 60 s rest

Four rounds of three minutes. Work straight through, then rest what is left of the round — usually 45 to 75 seconds. If a round leaves no rest at all, cut the reps by a third rather than running into the next round.

- 10 squat jumps
- 10 push-ups
- 20 mountain climbers
- 10 m bear crawl out, 10 m crab walk back
- 30 s jump rope, fast
- 10 bench step-ups each leg

0:51–0:56 · Block D — Last point



5 × 20 s work / 40 s rest

Five rounds: 20 seconds of maximum-intent footwork, 40 seconds of rest. Pick one attacking phrase before each round and run it repeatedly for the 20 seconds, as if the score were tied in the last minute.

Quality falls off here and that is the training effect. Keep the point on line and the recovery balanced even when the legs are asking not to.

0:56–1:00 · Cool-down



Easy throughout

Two minutes of walking until the breathing is normal again, then quad stretch 30 s each side, hamstring on the bench 30 s each side, hip flexor 30 s each side. Finish lying with calves on the bench for a minute of slow breathing.

Log line

date · 05 bout endurance · who · B round 1 __ lunges · B round 12 __ lunges · felt _/10